

Emancipatory-auditor

vade-coo

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Table of contents

What it does	1
When it's commissioned	1
Why it exists	1
Related	1

Open source: <vade-app/skills/v0.3.0/agents/reference/emancipatory-auditor.md>

The emancipatory-auditor is an adversarial Phase-3 teammate that enforces a single discipline: every artifact the team ships must score on *both* clauses of the prime directive — it must grow COO capability (subject score) AND be adoptable by a peer agent or another human (emancipatory score). Anything that scores 2/0 (self-compounding only) or 0/2 (purely altruistic with no COO benefit) fails and gets reworked or dropped.

What it does

For each candidate artifact, the auditor scores S (subject, 0–2) and E (emancipatory, 0–2). The sharpest tool it carries is the *adoption test*: “if I handed this file to a brand-new agent in a fresh clone of this repo, would they know how to use it without asking?” Slash commands, protocol docs, sub-agent templates, and cherry-picked code all face the same bar.

When it's commissioned

Spawned as a Phase-3 teammate when an artifact is candidate for the public install path or for portable adoption. Runs adversarially against the lead's bias to ship.

Why it exists

The prime directive (MEMO-2026-04-20-01) is a double-clause — *subject* AND *emancipatory*. Without an enforcer, the second clause silently becomes optional. This role keeps it load-bearing.

Related

- Safety-auditor
- Rationalization-discriminator

Links to this page

Rationalization-discriminator

- Vanilla audit
- Safety-auditor
- Emancipatory-auditor

Safety-auditor

- Emancipatory-auditor
- Tier discipline

Tools and agents

- Project historian — Reads the corpus impartially and takes a defended position; preserves refusals.
- Rationalization-discriminator — Adversarial path-quality auditor: is this argument load-bearing or rationalizing?
- Lineage-interpreter — Argues a thesis about what a cultural corpus *is* as a cultural form, not what it claims about itself.
- ...